TASK 5

CYBER CRIME & AWARENESS

UPI PAYMENT FRAUD CASE STUDY

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is a common type of cybercrime where scammers trick individuals into transferring money through fake payment requests or deceptive links. With the rise of digital payments in India, such fraud cases have increased significantly.

In a typical scenario, the fraudster contacts the victim through a phone call, SMS, or social media, pretending to be a bank official, delivery agent, or buyer. They send a “collect request” or a link and convince the victim that accepting it will help them receive money. However, when the victim enters their UPI PIN, money gets deducted instead. In some cases, scammers also ask for OTPs or sensitive banking details.

College students, elderly people, and individuals who are not fully aware of digital payment systems are the most common targets. People in urgent situations are especially vulnerable.

The consequences include financial loss, mental stress, and loss of trust in online platforms. Recovering the lost money is often difficult.

To prevent such fraud, users should never share their UPI PIN or OTP, avoid unknown links, and always verify payment requests carefully. Awareness and caution are essential to staying safe online.